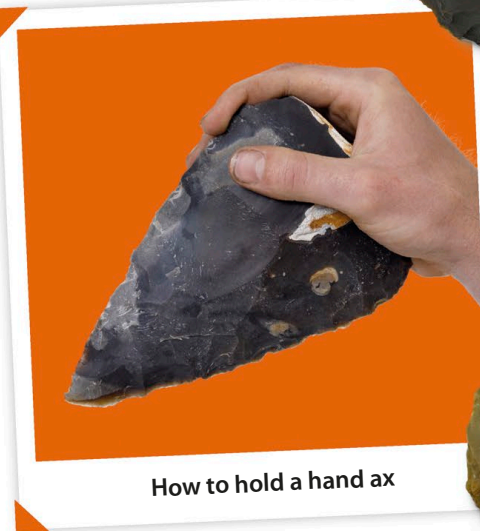


Stone tools

People in the Stone Age regularly needed to cut meat, scrape skins, and cut up plants. Stone was the best and most common material around to make tools to do these tasks. The earliest tools were rocks that had been hit with great force to create sharp edges. As people began using stone tools for special tasks, different styles developed.

Hand axes

Hand axes were one of the earliest and most popular tools in the Stone Age tool kit. They were especially useful for chopping meat, and were also used to break open bones and cut wood.



How to hold a hand ax



A straight blade was sharper than a hand ax.

Blades

Blades were struck from larger pieces of stone. They had lots of different uses, including carving out pieces of antler and bone that could be made into other tools.

WOW!

People used to call axes **“thunderstones”** as they thought they were made by **lightning!**

